



CM/Storytelling

31 CANADIAN BRIGADE GROUP
(31 CBG)

Andres J. Mona | MJCOM 9202 | March 11 2024

FOREWORD

Intro

My initial plan for the CM/Storytelling was to conduct a communications audit and review of the Children's Museum comms department, identify their weaknesses or shortcomings and then coordinate/develop content from there. Currently, the Children's Museum is in the middle of a major location change, to 100 Kellogg, and a social media campaign to promote their move to a larger and more modern space. The comms campaign is titled "Join the Journey." This move is also attached to a massive donation drive, the biggest in their history.

Community Partner - A dilemma

I met with their communications coordinator, Mira Noordermeer, in early January. She was very friendly and courteous and offered her department's deliverables and internal reports and products. However, after a second meeting in the middle of January, an issue quickly arose. They were interested in having content developed but only for the purposes of my project, they were not interested in publishing content. The Children's Museum was also resistant to my participation in their distribution planning for any content. Due to these constraints and the time-sensitivity of this project, with other project and assignments compounding, I chose to make a final change to my community partner: The Canada Army.

Specifically, for the purposes of this project I worked with 31 Canadian Brigade Group (31 CBG) to develop several different products. 31 CBG is a Reserve brigade-sized force that commands over two thousand soldiers across southwestern Ontario. 31 CBG supports domestic operations within various cities, London, Hamilton, Windsor, Niagara, Barrie and so on, as well as supporting national and internal operations. I am currently employed as a free-lancer with their PA department and have worked on different video projects, coordinated media events and developed written content.

Exercise Glacial Arrowhead

At the moment, 31 CBG is spearheading a major operation in northern Ontario named Glacial Arrowhead. Glacial Arrowhead is an exercise where soldiers will work with Indigenous and isolated communities in Moosonee and the surrounding area. They are not only practicing winter operations, such as survival in the cold but mainly strengthening relationships with those northern communities. Because of the limited size of the PA department at 31 CBG, their Public Affair Officer, Lieutenant Paul Verheye, was ecstatic to receive support. They mainly post on Facebook and Instagram, and typically post text-over-video TOV or interview style videos. Therefore, especially to demonstrate my ability to develop content with a specific intent and formally being a part of the distribution process, I chose to work with army public affairs.

Their initial request was far too much to begin with and what I ended up making for them instead were 3 videos and a poster. The three videos are specific to the Glacial Arrowhead exercise and the training building up to it. The poster is an internal product to increase the awareness of soldiers in the Brigade about how they can help with Public Affairs activities. Two of the three videos have been published on Facebook and Instagram, one video is in for review and the poster requires another draft.

STRATEGY

Goals

- 1) Increase public awareness about exercise Glacial Arrowhead.
- 2) Enhance internal awareness among 31 CBG soldiers about Public Affairs activities and encourage them to contribute content.

Objectives

Objective 1: Increase engagement on social media platforms, Facebook, and Instagram by 20% within the next three months through the dissemination of engaging video content.

Objective 2: Receive a 15% increase in submissions of photos and videos from 31 CBG soldiers to the Public Affairs Office within the next two months.

Strategies

Strategy 1: Develop compelling video content highlighting the soldiers' preparation and participation in exercise Glacial Arrowhead.

Strategy 2: Create an informative poster to raise internal awareness among 31 CBG soldiers about contributing content to PA activities.

Tactics

Tactic 1: Video Production

- Showcase training activities and interviews with key personnel – communicate relevant information about exercise.
- Utilize a mix of interview-style videos and TOV formats to cater to different audiences and mediums.

Tactic 2: Poster Development

- Revise the poster to correct mistakes and enhance visual appeal.
- Ensure clear messaging directing soldiers to submit their photos and videos to the Public Affairs Office.

Tactic 3: Social Media Distribution

- Schedule release of remaining videos on Facebook during pique audience and user engagement times, used tools like Meta Business Suite.
- Utilize bilingual captioning and hashtags to optimize reach and engagement.
- Communicate with the largest possible audience and comply with government regulations for social media content.

Tactic 4: Metrics Tracking

- Implement tools such as Meta Business Suite to track engagement metrics and adjust posting strategies accordingly.
- Monitor submissions of photos and videos to assess the effectiveness of internal awareness efforts for Public Affairs.

Implementation Timeline

- Work with Public Affairs Officer to schedule and post content on social media throughout the month of February and early March. 5-day turn-around on post-production.
- Monitor engagement metrics and submission rates 3 days, 6 days and 9 days after the post using Meta Business Suite.
- Complete poster revisions and finalize video production and all other post-production by Monday March 04, 2024.

Metrics and Evaluation

KPI 1 - Increase engagement on social media platforms by 20% within the next three months through the dissemination of engaging video content.

- 1) Increase in total likes, comments, and shares on Facebook and Instagram posts related to Exercise Glacial Arrowhead.
- 2) Positive growth in the number of followers on Facebook and Instagram.
- 3) Increase the average watch time for each video post BY 30%

KPI 2: Receive a 15% increase in submissions of photos and videos from 31 CBG soldiers to the Public Affairs Office within the next two months.

- 1) Receive 5 submissions at least per week, 20 per month.
- 2) Assess the quality of submitted content based on relevance, originality, and adherence to guidelines.
- 3) Receive feedback from soldiers regarding the ease of submission process and their awareness of Public Affairs activities.

KPI 3: Increase overall awareness of Exercise Glacial Arrowhead and Public Affairs activities among 31 CBG soldiers.

- 1) Conduct pre and post-campaign surveys to measure awareness levels among soldiers regarding Exercise Glacial Arrowhead and Public Affairs activities.
- 2) Tally the number of soldiers who engage with the poster or inquire about submitting content to the Public Affairs Office.
- 3) Gather feedback from soldiers on the effectiveness of the poster in raising awareness about Public Affairs activities.

Roles and Responsibilities

Videographer, editor, interviewer: Andres Mona – Responsible for video production, poster design and content distribution.

Public Affairs Officer: Paul Verheye – Oversee the implementation of the comms plan (if one in place) and coordinate with videographer to develop content, edit products and aid in distribution plan.

Review and Revision

- Schedule at least three meetings with the Public Affairs Officer to discuss content in depth.
- Regular phone calls and Zoom meetings.
- Meetings after content is posted to discuss outcome and plans moving forward.
- Make necessary revisions based on metrics and user engagement.

Approval

Final Approval of content and distribution strategies rests with Lieutenant Paul Verheye, Public Affairs Officer of 31 CBG.

STORY PURPOSE

Purpose

The purpose of the three videos I developed was to increase the public awareness about exercise Glacial Arrowhead, especially to highlight how soldiers from southwestern Ontario are heading north to confirm their skills operating in subarctic conditions. Glacial Arrowhead is an exercise that is being conducted in Moosonee and other townships such as Moose Factory, from March 8 to 17. They are practicing and confirming survival and warfighting skills in subarctic conditions, as well as playing a public outreach role by meeting and working with Indigenous/local communities.

The three videos I made ended up forming a part of a greater social media campaign to promote and increase awareness of exercise Glacial Arrowhead. The Public Affairs Office was explicit that they wanted to showcase content that is not typically shown about the army and to focus on its most basic and ‘fun’ aspects; in this case, to showcase the soldiers as learning but also essentially camping for fun.

Video Breakdown

The first video I made was the snowmobile TOV, which was filmed and edited during the weekend of February 15 to 17. It was made to foster awareness on concurrent training as well as to showcase the more playful aspects of the military. This video is titled: “Snowmobile Course.”

The second video was an interview with Lieutenant-Colonel Carlo Tittarelli on another training exercise in preparation for March, Arrowhead Chill 2. Here, soldiers were practicing setting up and tearing down arctic tents, starting stoves and lanterns, and using toboggans and tools; all which will be used in Moosonee for survival. Again, in line with the first video, this was made to increase awareness of Glacial Arrowhead. This video was titled: “Arrowhead Chill 2 Interview.”

The final video was a short interview with Lieutenant Verheye on March 8, as soldiers were deploying and on their way to Moosonee. This last video was titled: “Glacial Arrowhead Interview.”

Poster Breakdown

The final product I developed, unrelated to the Glacial Arrowhead campaign but noted from the shortcomings faced while developing content, was the poster.

This poster was made to increase internal awareness among 31 CBG soldiers about Public Affairs and directed them to an email and QR code with an email to send photos and videos. Because of the very limited staffing at the Public Affairs department, they had me create a poster that would promote soldiers to send in content, thus lessening the load on the Public Affairs Officer.

TARGET AUDIENCE AND INTENDED OUTCOME

Videos – Target Audience & Intended Outcome

Immediately, when planning the three videos, an issue arose with the 31 CBG Public Affairs department – they really did not know who they would be targeting. Because of the limited reach of Canadian Military social media, and because most of the audience are themselves soldiers, or family and friends of one. It only made sense to create the video series on Glacial Arrowhead as a sort of ‘heads up’ to other soldiers.

The videos showcase fun and cool training that can be done and showcase how soldiers can help out a work with isolated communities in northern Ontario, an opportunity that few experience. Therefore, the intended audience was the soldiers in 31 Brigade. However, as with most products – the Public Affairs Office also wanted to double the content’s intention to act as recruiting. Most internal products, honestly and no matter the content, are typically double-hatted as recruiting promotion.

The intended outcome for these videos was to generate more interest, Glacial Arrowhead is a concurrent and yearly held exercise. 31 CBG hosts the Arctic Operations Group, which deploys to the arctic at least twice a year. This is one of the biggest exercises for the Brigade and they would like to see an increase in numbers by next year, more numbers also mean an increase in funding.

Poster – Target Audience & Intended Outcome

Equally and more so due to its content, the poster was created with 31 CBG soldiers in mind, to increase awareness of their ability to work with Public Affairs. The intended outcome will be to increase the volume of photos and videos sent to the Public Affairs Office, increase the number of products developed and make those with comms, graphic design, and marketing skills aware.

FRAMING & SEO

Framing

Due to the fact that the content and products I developed are intended mainly for a military audience the general presentation of the videos comes with a serious tone. The video is informational but uses the voices of specific characters such as the Lieutenant Colonel to communicate this information to the audience. An interview format was chosen because of the connection that is possible through a person speaking, rather than the snowmobile video that only provides text and music to inform the audience.

Equally, when making the poster simple color scheme with red and a photo of a Canadian soldier with a camera was sufficient to communicate the intent of the poster.

Furthermore, the large QR code pushes the audience to scan it and send their products to the Public Affairs Office.

Social Media Text

For the text attached to the videos, I created both texts which were used on Facebook and Instagram posts. I also translated them into French. All content developed by the Government, provincial or federal, must be created bilingually. I have included both examples below:

Arrowhead Chill 2 Interview Text (Bilingual)
Glacial Arrowhead is only a few days away, and we are ready! Soldiers developed their skills during Ex Arrowhead Chill #2 at CFB Borden February 9-11, 2024, which simulated living conditions that will be found when we deploy. All of this is done to prepare us to deploy around Canada's North should we be called upon to support the isolated communities in those regions.

Contact your local recruiter and get more information on how you can be a part of groups that support your fellow Canadians in times of need at <https://www.canada.ca/.../31-canadian-brigade-group.html>

CAx  MCpl Mona, 31 CBG PA & Cpl Nechita, 32 CBG PA

Glacial Arrowhead n'est que dans quelques jours, et nous sommes prêts ! Les soldats ont développé leurs compétences lors de l'Ex Arrowhead Chill #2 à la BFC Borden du 9 au 11 février 2024, qui simulait les conditions de vie que nous retrouverons lors de notre déploiement.

Tout cela est fait pour nous préparer à nous déployer dans le Nord canadien si nous étions appelés à soutenir les communautés isolées de ces régions.

Contactez votre recruteur local et obtenez plus d'informations sur la façon dont vous pouvez faire partie de groupes qui soutiennent vos concitoyens canadiens en cas de besoin sur <https://www.canada.ca/.../corporate/4-canadian-division/31.-groupe-brigade-canadienne.html>

Glacial Arrowhead Text (Bilingual)

GLACIAL Arrowhead is here! We are on our way to Moosonee Ontario, which is running March 8-17, 2024. This training is crucial for operating in Arctic and Sub-Arctic climates, and supporting the North should we be called upon.

If you are interested in this kind of training, or like winter camping find your local recruiter and get more information at <https://www.canada.ca/.../31-canadian-brigade-group.html>... and join up today!

GLACIAL Arrowhead est là ! Nous sommes en route vers Moosonee, en Ontario, qui se déroulera du 8 au 17 mars 2024. Cette formation est cruciale pour opérer dans les climats arctiques et subarctiques et pour soutenir le Nord si nous sommes appelés.

Si vous êtes intéressé par ce type de formation ou si vous aimez le camping d'hiver, trouvez votre recruteur local et obtenez plus d'informations sur <https://www.canada.ca/.../31-groupe-brigade-du-canada.html>

SEO & Hashtags

When thinking of SEO and Hashtags, I sat down with the Public Affair Officer Verheye to develop several. I have included examples below.

These first few hashtags are an example of what is normally used by 31 CBG on their Facebook and Instagram posts. These will typically be seen on or attached to most content:

#31CBG #31GBC #MyCAF #MesFAC #proudstrongready #FortsFiersPrêts #armyexercise
#armystrong #canadianarmy #armycanadienne #canadianarmedforces
#Forcesarméescanadiennes

The following were created by Verheye and me, they were ultimately chosen and vetted by him as the Public Affairs Officer.

Examples from Arrowhead Chill Video:

#trainingday #camping #campinglife #campingchallenge #wintercamping

Examples from Glacial Arrowhead Interview:

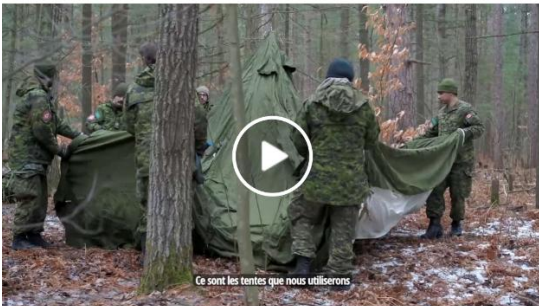
#winterwonderland #snowmobile #trainingday

SOCIAL MEDIA POSTS

Arrowhead Chill Video

 **31 Canadian Brigade Group - 31e Groupe-
Brigade Du Canada** ...
6d · 🌐

Glacial Arrowhead is only a few days away, and we are ready! Soldiers developed their skills during Ex Arrowhead Chill #2 at CFB Borden February ... See more



👍 3CRPG - 3GPRC and 20 others

👍 21 💬 ➦ 2

facebook Log in

 **31 Canadian Brigade Group - 31e Groupe-
Brigade Du Canada** ...
6d · 🌐

Glacial Arrowhead is only a few days away, and we are ready! Soldiers developed their skills during Ex Arrowhead Chill #2 at CFB Borden February 9-11, 2024, which simulated living conditions that will be found when we deploy.

All of this is done to prepare us to deploy around Canada's North should we be called upon to support the isolated communities in those regions.

Contact your local recruiter and get more information on how you can be a part of groups that support your fellow Canadians in times of need at <https://www.canada.ca/en/army/corporate/4-canadian-division/31-canadian-brigade-group.html>

🇨🇦 🇺🇸 MCpl Mona, 31 CBG PA & Cpl Nechita, 32 CBG PA

Glacial Arrowhead Video

facebook

Log in

31 Canadian Brigade Group - 31e Groupe-Brigade Du Canada

1d ·

GLACIAL Arrowhead is here! We are on our way to Moosonee Ontario, which is running March 8-17, 2024. This training is crucial for operating in Arctic and Sub-Arctic climates, and supporting the North should we be called upon.

If you are interested in this kind of training, or... See more

Brad Farrow and 22 others

31 Canadian Brigade Group - 31e Groupe-Brigade Du Canada

1d ·

STRUCTURE

The Poster

The Poster, as the standalone piece, was made with simplicity in mind. It contains a short text at the bottom directing the audience to an email address to send their content. There is a picture of a soldier with a camera, and he is pointing it towards a QR code, that when scanned takes a person directly to their email. It contains a simple two-color palette scheme reinforcing that simple but direct design.

The poster is currently on its second draft and has one spelling mistake at the bottom: “*imargery*” instead of “*imagery*.”

The Three Videos

The three videos are meant to be presented in tandem and support one another. All three act as a part of a larger series to raise awareness about the exercise Glacial Arrowhead.

The longer interview/video titled “Arrowhead Chill” acts as the main introduction to Glacial Arrowhead and provides the key details concerning the exercise. It opens on a higher-up, Lieutenant Colonel Tittarelli, who is a commander of the operation. He explains how the soldiers are training with tents, why they are doing it and how these tools will be used to face the challenges of subarctic conditions up in Moosonee. It’s interspersed with shots of soldiers working with tents, stoves and lanterns, it also showcases the snowmobiles. The other two videos really are a support to this main one.

The snowmobile video is shorter and contains no dialogue, only text, to showcase a more interesting and exciting form of training. It shows how exactly soldiers will be transported in the north and how they will be able to move the toboggans and tents shown in the previous video. It is full of action shots as the soldiers practice their driving skills.

Finally, the video interview with Paul Verheye takes place in Moosonee and showcases the soldier’s trip to get up there. This video acts as a sort of update and introduction to the beginning of the exercise that is currently underway.

COMMUNITY PARTNER PRESENTATION & DISTRIBUTION

As stated earlier, two of the three videos have been released/published on Facebook and Instagram. While the poster remains awaiting approval or return for any final changes. All products are currently in the hands of the 31 CBG Public Affairs Office.

The videos were captured in February, with the first being the longer form interview with the colonel. Each of these products had about a 5 day turn around. Therefore, when I captured the footage for the interview on February 9 to 11, it was posted a little over a week later. Work was sent to the Public Affairs Officer Verheye over WeTransfer and any changes or corrections to the videos were also coordinated remotely.

For the distribution, I sat down with Verheye to use Meta’s Business Suite, which is an app that permits social media content to be scheduled. Equally it provides metrics on audience clicks, user activities, user concurrence on pages and post activity. Utilizing this tool, we planned each of the videos to be released following 31 CBG’s social media posting schedule. They post on Wednesday and Thursday, from 4 to 5 o’clock. I also took these opportunities to develop the text and hashtags in tandem with the Public Affairs Officer.

PROCESS

The process for filming and gathering the necessary material for the videos was extremely easy. Army exercises are typically scheduled for weekends, especially when reservists are involved, as most members hold regular jobs or schooling during the week. Lieutenant Verheye was able to schedule and communicate the dates for this exercise and the content he wanted created from them usually a week in anticipation.

Equipment was also readily available as the brigade has several cameras, GoPro's and other filming equipment available. Due to the conditions and the weather, I filmed in, I chose to mainly use their equipment to not risk FIMS property.

Due to my rank and role in the military as Master Corporal (equivalent to Sergeant) and my title as Public Affairs representative, gathering videos and interviews was also extremely easy. I was able to work with the courses without disturbing their training and was given near unlimited access to their facilities and training areas. Furthermore, higher ranked individuals were also keener and more open to being interviewed as I was sent by the authority of the Public Affairs Officer. Therefore, conducting the interviews was as easy as showing up on location at the right date and time, and then speaking with people until someone agreed to be interviewed. I had prepared several questions each time and coached each of the interviewees on the basics: not to look at the camera, to pause and give themselves time if they messed up, to restate the question in their answer. Etc. Thankfully, the people I chose to interview already had some considerable experience interacting with the media.

The activities I was also sent on were wildly varied and dealing with the considerations of the cold in Petawawa, where most of the training was done, was a great learning experience. For example, I had initially brought a go-pro to capture the snowmobile footage, unfortunately due to poor planning on my part, I left the batteries in London. So instead, I rode on the back of a snowmobile while holding a camera in one hand and holding on with the other. It was not only super fun and a great experience but also made me feel like one of those photographers that captures cycling – most of my body hanging out from the vehicle.

TECH NOTES

I used DaVinci Resolve to make the videos and I used Photoshop to make the posters. All video and photography were captured and edited by me. The products are from scratch and the animations, symbols and sequences were all created by me.

The Poster

The most blatant flaw of the poster is the spelling mistake in the word “imagery” (imagery). In terms of improvement, the font could be changed to something more catching the eye. As well, as the space between letters could be increased. Also, the white space at the top of the poster, where “Submit Your Photos” sits could be cropped, and the title brought lower.

The Videos

Over the course of February, I compiled the footage for two of the videos. A few days ago on the 8th, the same day that the soldiers departed for Moosonee, I captured video and photos of them leaving London. Footage from Moosonee and as they travelled north was

provided by the Public Affairs Officer, as well as filming his own interview in the community center. I collected all necessary material and used DaVinci to compile the videos together. In terms of future improvements, more work on the color correction would have made the colours pop in the video, as well as certain segments of the snowmobile video being a bit bright.

However, I am quite proud of how I created certain animations and symbols. For example, the outro on both videos with the Canada logo at the end and then the military symbols with the copyright were made by me. I did this by researching and watching a few of the Canada military's videos. I then downloaded one and Frankensteined it to cut out the Canada logo and the sound effect. Furthermore, I then saved a bunch of logos from Google of the brigades and then used photoshop AI to increase their quality. I then copied word-for-word the final copyright and then incorporated both into my video. These outros are now being used by the 31 CBG Public Affairs Office.

COMMUNITY PARTNER INFO

Content permissions granted by Lt. Paul Verheye, 31 CBG PAO

31 Canadian Brigade Group, Public Affairs Office.
Email: 31cbgimagery@gmail.com
Public Affairs Officer: Lieutenant Paul Verheye.
Cell: 519 854-5603
Email(s): paul.verheye@gmail.com ; paul.verheye@forces.gc.ca .

NOTES TO ERIN

This now concludes my rationale paper for the CM/Storytelling Project. This project really did not progress nor finish as expected. Initially and as I explained in the Foreword, I had planned to work with the Children's Museum and their comms team. Once that did not pan out and I was not happy with the results of my meetings and outreach, I switched to working with the Army.

I think that this choice was the best and most advantageous and allowed to develop various products, as well as being able to be an active part of the distribution process and social media planning behind it.

In retrospect it would have been apt to have communicated with you Erin about this change. It might have also been necessary or useful to have created a new proposal for this community partner. However, and in the end, the content I made fits with the project's guidelines. Also, generally I learned quite a bit more about government public affairs planning and was mortified to see how little of this is currently implemented at 31 CBG – for example with Officer lacking a target audience for the content, as well as their extremely limited staffing.

The opportunities I had for filming and the people I worked with and spoke to were excellent. I was also able to develop very distinct types of content, which was awesome practice as well. Finally, I got paid to do this work and have had most of it published.

Ultimately, this project was interesting to accomplish, and I will leave this rationale paper with a final few recommendations.

Recommendations

- 31 CBG Public Affairs must develop a comms plan in order to develop and coordinate content.
- All content must be given to a target audience and should be attached to a larger social media campaign – such as is the case with the exercise Glacial Arrowhead.
- 31 CBG must expand their staffing, they should utilize the Brigade and canvass for volunteers to support Public Affairs operations.
- 31 CBG should use metric tracking tools such as Google Analytics or Meta Business Suite to track post success, as well as plan social media posting and modify according to audience habits.
- Recruiting content should be created with that specific intent, no more double-hatting or multi-purposing posts without a plan.
- When making or choosing hashtags, use platforms like SemRush to optimize SEO and find the most effective keywords.
- For French translations, canvass organization and use bilingual members. 4 Division, which commands 31 CBG, 32 CBG and 33 CBG, also has a language school and could be utilized to correct translations.